
ATG

INTERNAL DECISION DOCUMENT

AI TRADING BOT HOSTING DECISION

Which Windows VPS to run MT5 on, what it costs, and the fine print

WHAT IT DOES

AI analyses forex markets & places trades on MetaTrader 5

MARKET DATA

Free — Nasdaq.com & Yahoo Finance

HOSTING

Windows VPS with MT5 installed

MONTHLY COST

~R475 - R792 / month

DECISION REQUIRED

01

WHAT WE'RE HOSTING

ATG's product is an **AI-powered automated forex trading bot**. It pulls free market data from Nasdaq.com and Yahoo Finance, uses AI to analyse price action and market conditions, and places trades directly on **MetaTrader 5 (MT5)**.

There are no subscribers, no website, no web dashboard. It is a background process that runs on a server 24 hours a day during market hours, making trades autonomously.

WHAT WE NEED

COMPONENT	WHAT IT DOES
Windows VPS	A virtual server running Windows. MT5 is a Windows application — it needs Windows to run. The AI bot runs on the same server alongside MT5.
MetaTrader 5	Installed directly on the Windows VPS. MT5 connects to the forex broker. The AI bot uses MT5's built-in Python API to analyse markets and place trades — no middleman, no bridge service.
Market Data	Free — pulled from Nasdaq.com and Yahoo Finance. No paid data feed required.
Storage	Disk space for trade logs, AI model data, and price history. 40–100 GB SSD is more than enough.

What we DO NOT need: A Linux server, a CDN, a load balancer, Cloudflare, a managed database, object storage, or multiple servers. This is one bot + MT5 on one Windows VPS. That's it.

HOW IT WORKS — THE SETUP

The complete setup on the Windows VPS:

1. Rent a **Windows VPS** from a provider (Vultr, Hetzner, or similar)
2. Install **MetaTrader 5** on the VPS and log in with your broker account
3. Install **Python** on the VPS
4. Deploy the **AI trading bot** — it uses MT5's Python library to read market data, run analysis, and place trades
5. The bot runs 24/7 during market hours. You can remote-desktop into the VPS anytime to monitor it.

WHY WINDOWS VPS?

MetaTrader 5 is a **Windows application**. It does not run natively on Linux. The simplest, most reliable approach is a Windows VPS where MT5 and the AI bot run together on the same machine. No bridge services, no workarounds, no third-party dependencies between the bot and the broker. **One server, one bill.**

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WINDOWS VPS PROVIDERS — WITH FINE PRINT

Two providers offer Windows VPS hosting with servers in South Africa. Below is what each costs, what's included, and **the fine print they don't tell you upfront**.

Vultr

VULTR.COM — JOHANNESBURG — USD PRICING

RECOMMENDED

International cloud provider with a Johannesburg data centre. Offers Windows VPS out of the box.

What We'd Use

ITEM	VCPUS	RAM	DISK	BANDWIDTH	MONTHLY (USD)	MONTHLY (~ZAR AT R18/\$)
Cloud Compute (Regular)	2	4 GB	100 GB SSD	3 TB	\$24	~R432
Windows Server licence	Included with Windows template					+\$16 (~R288)
TOTAL						\$40 (~R720/mo)

⚠ Vultr Fine Print — Read Before You Sign Up

USD billing only: Vultr invoices in US Dollars. If the rand moves from R18/\$ to R22/\$, your R720/mo becomes **R880/mo**. The service doesn't change — only your bill does. This is real FX risk on a recurring cost.

"Per hour" billing explained: You are charged \$0.060/hr for this plan (server + Windows). The monthly price (\$40) is a **cap** — you never pay more than \$40/month even though $0.060 \times 720 \text{ hours} = \43.20 . The system charges whichever is lower. If you run 24/7 (which you will — the bot trades around the clock), you always pay the capped monthly rate.

Stopping vs. destroying: "Stopping" a server (shutting it down) does **NOT** stop billing. Your disk, IP address, and resources are still reserved for you. **Only destroying/deleting the server stops charges.** If you want to pause costs, you must destroy the server — but you lose everything unless you backed it up.

Bandwidth: 3 TB/month included (clearly stated). A trading bot pulling price data uses a fraction of this. Overage charges apply beyond 3 TB but you won't hit it.

IP address: 1 IPv4 included. Additional IPs cost \$3/mo each. You only need 1.

Backups: Optional, **adds 20% to monthly cost** (\$8/mo = ~R144/mo). Automatic weekly snapshots. Recommended — if the server dies, you can restore from backup in minutes.

Snapshots: On-demand snapshots are free (up to storage limits). Good for before-and-after backups when updating the bot code.

Windows licence: The \$16/mo Windows Server licence is **mandatory** if you choose a Windows template. You cannot bring your own licence on Vultr cloud compute.

Remote Desktop (RDP): Included with Windows. You connect to your VPS over Remote Desktop to install MT5, deploy the bot, and monitor it. No extra cost.

Pros

- ✓ Windows VPS ready out of the box
- ✓ 100 GB SSD, 3 TB bandwidth included
- ✓ Johannesburg data centre
- ✓ Hourly billing capped at monthly rate
- ✓ Free snapshots, optional auto-backup
- ✓ Mature platform, well-documented
- ✓ Can resize server in minutes if needed

Cons

- ✗ USD billing — exchange rate risk
- ✗ ~R720/mo is the most expensive option
- ✗ Stopped server still charges

Hetzner South Africa

HETZNER.CO.ZA — JOHANNESBURG — ZAR PRICING

BUDGET OPTION

South African hosting company. Dedicated servers (bare metal) with optional Windows. ZAR pricing — no exchange rate risk.

What We'd Use

ITEM	CPU	RAM	DISK	BANDWIDTH	MONTHLY (EX. VAT)
Dedicated Server (e.g. RS-8)	Intel Xeon	8 GB	2 TB HDD	Unmetered	~R350
+ 15% VAT					~R403 incl.

⚠ Hetzner Fine Print

Bare metal (not cloud): This is a physical machine, not a virtual one. You rent actual hardware. It's powerful, but if it breaks, Hetzner replaces the hardware — which can take **hours or longer**. During that time, your bot is offline and not trading.

Windows licence: Hetzner can provide Windows Server at an additional monthly fee. Check current pricing — it varies. You install Windows yourself or request it pre-installed.

No cloud flexibility: You cannot "resize" a dedicated server. If you need more RAM or CPU, you order a different server and migrate manually. With cloud providers you click a button.

Full sysadmin responsibility: OS updates, security patches, firewall rules, backups — all on you. There is no managed service layer.

HDD, not SSD: The base RS-8 uses traditional hard drives, not SSDs. HDD is slower for AI model loading and data reads. SSD upgrades are available at extra cost.

Setup fee: Dedicated servers may have a one-off setup fee. Confirm with Hetzner before ordering.

Monthly billing only: No hourly billing. You pay for the full month. If you cancel mid-month, you still owe the full month.

Single point of failure: One physical machine. If it fails, everything stops. No automatic failover. Cloud VPS providers typically recover faster because they can spin up a new VM from a backup.

Pros

- ✓ Cheapest option (~R403/mo incl. VAT)
- ✓ ZAR billing — no exchange rate risk
- ✓ More raw power (Xeon + 8 GB)
- ✓ Unmetered bandwidth

Cons

- ✗ Single physical machine — if it dies, bot stops
- ✗ Full sysadmin responsibility
- ✗ Cannot resize — must migrate to new server
- ✗ HDD not SSD (slower)
- ✗ No hourly billing — monthly commitment
- ✗ Possible setup fee
- ✗ Hardware failures take hours to fix

WHAT ABOUT CLOUDAFRICA?

CloudAfrica (cloudafrica.net) is a South African cloud provider with ZAR pricing. However, they offer **Linux only** — no Windows VPS option. Since MT5 requires Windows, CloudAfrica is **not suitable** for this use case.

GITHUB — CODE REPOSITORY

You need somewhere to store the bot's source code, track changes, and deploy updates. **GitHub** is the standard.

PLAN	PRICE	WHAT YOU GET
Free	\$0/mo	Unlimited private repos. 500 MB packages storage. 2,000 CI/CD minutes/mo. Limited Copilot access. Good enough if you're just storing code.
Pro	\$4/mo (~R72)	Everything in Free + required reviewers, code owners, branch protection rules, 2 GB packages, 3,000 CI/CD minutes. Pages in private repos.
Team	\$4/user/ mo	Everything in Pro + team access controls, draft PRs, multiple reviewers. Only needed if 2+ developers.

⚠️ GitHub Fine Print

Free plan is enough to start. If you're one developer, the Free plan gives you unlimited private repos. You only need Pro or Team when you want branch protection or have multiple developers.

USD billing: GitHub bills in USD. Same FX risk as Vultr.

CI/CD minutes: If you use GitHub Actions to auto-deploy the bot to your VPS, the 2,000 free minutes/mo is more than enough. You won't hit this limit.

Copilot: GitHub Copilot (AI coding assistant) costs \$10/mo extra. Optional, not required.

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SIDE-BY-SIDE COMPARISON

	VULTR (WINDOWS VPS)	HETZNER SA (DEDICATED)
Monthly Cost	~R720 (\$40 at R18/\$)	~R403 (incl. VAT, excl. Windows fee)
Currency	USD (variable with FX)	ZAR (fixed)
If Rand Goes to R22/\$	Jumps to ~R880	Still ~R403
Server Type	Cloud (virtual machine)	Dedicated (physical machine)
CPU / RAM	2 vCPUs / 4 GB	Intel Xeon / 8 GB
Disk	100 GB SSD	2 TB HDD
Bandwidth	3 TB included	Unmetered
Windows Included?	Yes (\$16/mo included in total)	Extra fee — confirm with Hetzner
MT5 Runs Natively?	Yes — install directly on Windows	Yes — if Windows is installed
Backups	Optional (+20% = ~R144/mo)	DIY — no managed backup
Can Resize?	Yes — click a button, minutes	No — order new server, migrate
If Hardware Fails	New VM spins up from backup (minutes)	Physical replacement (hours+)
Billing Model	Hourly, capped at monthly	Monthly only
Stopped Server Charges?	Yes — must destroy to stop billing	N/A — always monthly

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TOTAL COST & RECOMMENDATION

WHAT YOU'LL PAY EACH MONTH

ITEM	VULTR WINDOWS VPS	HETZNER DEDICATED
Server	\$24 (~R432)	~R350 ex. VAT (~R403 incl.)
Windows Server licence	\$16 (~R288) — included	Extra — confirm with Hetzner
MetaTrader 5	Free (download from broker)	Free (download from broker)
Market data (Nasdaq + Yahoo)	R0 (free APIs)	R0 (free APIs)
GitHub (code repository)	\$4/mo (~R72) — Pro plan	\$4/mo (~R72) — Pro plan
Optional: Auto-backup	+\$8/mo (~R144) — recommended	DIY
TOTAL (without backup)	~R792/mo	~R475/mo + Windows fee
TOTAL (with backup)	~R936/mo	~R475/mo + Windows + DIY

R792

VULTR — READY TO GO (USD RISK)

~R475+

HETZNER — CHEAPEST (MORE RISK)

R72

GITHUB PRO (INCLUDED IN TOTALS)

RECOMMENDATION

For a production AI trading bot handling real money: **Vultr Windows VPS + GitHub Pro at ~R792/mo.**

You get a Windows server in Johannesburg, install MT5, deploy the bot, and trade. Everything is on one machine. Backups are one click. If something breaks, Vultr restores it in minutes. You can resize the server if the bot needs more power.

Hetzner is cheaper (~R475/mo) but it's a physical machine — if it fails, you're offline for hours while real trades could be running. No easy backups, no resizing, more sysadmin work. The saving is not worth the risk when real money is on the line.

The FX risk is real — if the rand weakens to R22/\$, Vultr goes to ~R880/mo. But even at R22/\$, the reliability advantage is worth it for a live trading bot.

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DECISION SUMMARY

#	QUESTION	ANSWER
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1	What are we hosting?	An AI bot that analyses forex markets and places trades on MetaTrader 5
2	What kind of server?	Windows VPS — because MT5 is a Windows application
3	Where does market data come from?	Free — Nasdaq.com and Yahoo Finance APIs
4	Are there subscribers or users?	No. The bot runs on its own. No website, no dashboard.
5	Recommended provider?	Vultr (Johannesburg, Windows VPS)
6	Monthly cost?	~R792/mo (Vultr \$40 + GitHub \$4 at R18/\$)
7	Does "per hour" billing mean extra cost?	No. Hourly is capped at the monthly rate. Running 24/7 = you pay the monthly price, never more.
8	Does a "stopped" server still cost money?	Yes. You must destroy the server to stop billing. Stopping just shuts it down but keeps charging.
9	Do we need Cloudflare / CDN / load balancer?	No. There is no website. Just a bot running on a server.
10	Do we need multiple servers?	No. One Windows VPS runs MT5 + the bot. That's all.

Prepared by: ATG

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Exchange rate assumption: R18 = \$1 USD (indicative). Vultr costs will vary with FX.

Next step: Sign up for Vultr, deploy a Windows VPS in Johannesburg, install MT5, and deploy the bot. Set up a private GitHub repo for the bot code.